



EMMANUEL AHIMANA

PROFESSIONAL DANCER | CHOREOGRAPHER

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Kigali, Rwanda

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

A dance professional, known for innovative choreography that seamlessly blends various styles and elevates storytelling. My passion for dancing can be traced back to my pre-professional days when I discovered that dancing makes me whole and the love, passion, and gift to dance came to me like a birthright. Whether as part of different teams I joined, performing in different festivals and dancing competitions, I have been one of the best from the start.

In my dance journey, I got an opportunity to meet many of the best ballet dancers and great choreographers in the world like Misty Copeland an American ballet dancer for American Ballet Theatre, Royce Zackery from Howard University and Kirvin Douthit-Boyd a former dancer of Alvin Aileys American Dance Theatre and current co-Artistic director of COCA from whom I learnt a lot and gained the guiding inspiration towards my professional dance career growth.

DANCE EXPERIENCE

- **From July 1 to July 6, 2026**, I Performed my solo dance piece *IREBE* at the Kenya National Theatre during the dance Life Festival.
- **From May 5 to May 10, 2026**, I collaborated with Ingomanshya Company as the choreographer for their new production, *INGOMANSHYA*, which is now on tour.
- **February 26th to March 6th, 2026**, I choreographed and performed LES NOCES DE SUZANNE, in collaboration with Compagnie STEIN-LEIN-CHEN and OPERA KIVU.
- **October, 2025**, I joined ISHYAKA ry'Intore Traditional dance troop and performed in the yearly concert named NZAZICUNDIRA.
- **May 16th to 24th, 2025**, I participated in Choreography Workshop that was prepared by L'Espace and led by a renowned Choreographer Adonis Nébié from Burkina Faso.
- **January 19th to 28th, 2025**, I took part in KIVUNYIKA RESIDENCE, which was led by the ATEKA Dance Company's artistic director and famous choreographer Abdoulaye Trésor Konaté. During this experience, I learnt how to approach and execute the movements in many ways in real life.
- I successfully participated in the International professional internship - Black urban and contemporary dances which was held from **July 15 to August 11, 2024**, at the **École des Sables**, Toubab Dialaw, Senegal.

- **April 25th, 2024**, I performed in Tanzania at Muda Africa the piece named “Multitude “by Wesley Ruzibiza.
- **February 28th, 2024**, I joined the production of a piece named “the gift of time” by Wesley Ruzibiza as an assistant choreographer and a performer in Kwibuka 30 the genocide against the Tutsi in Rwanda with 130 dancers on the stage and performed on 7th of April 2024.
- **January 25th, 2024**, I joined Amizero dance company and joined the new production process of a new piece name “Multitude” and performed it as an out of residence performance in the Kigali Triennial Festival.
- **From August 2023 to October 2023:** I led a training session in 3 Refugee Camps in Rwanda and trained about 30+ dance Instructors in different dance styles (Ballet and contemporary).
- **From January 2022 – Present:** I became an Assistant Dance Instructor at MindLeaps, and I ran classes of my own and I also assist in many other classes when senior instructors are absent or have prior engagements.
- **From 2021 – 2022:** I assisted senior dance instructors with their dance classes at MindLeaps.
- **In 2019:** I choreographed and performed in Anda Arts festival.
- **In 2021:**
 - I performed into Ubuntu Festival again in Kigali / Rwanda.
 - I got a chance to be trained by Kirvin Douthit-Boyd a former dancer of Alvin Aileys American Dance Theatre and current co-Artistic director of COCA for Ubumuntu Art Festival 2021 performance.
- **In 2016** I was able to attend different festivals as a dancer like Ubuntu Festival with the theme “I am because you are.”
- I started training more in all forms of dance, but especially enjoyed modern dance, Ballet, Contemporary, Afro African.
- **In 2014:** I joined an NGO named MindLeaps and started chasing my dreams.
- **In 2008:** Through my joyful magical childhood, I started dancing by imitating my siblings while dancing traditional dances at home.

DANCE TECHNICAL & SOFT SKILLS

- Solid experience / expertise in various dance routines and styles including but not limited to Contemporary, ballet and other various choreographic styles like Hip-Hop, Jazz, and Afro.
 - Talented and solid experience in dance composition, dance improvisation, flexibility, rhythmic, posture understanding, teamwork, contemporary dance, and classic ballet.
 - Strong knowledge of dance techniques, music, costumes, positional awareness, drama, reliable, ballet, creativity and innovation, collaboration skills, balance, and physical fitness.

- Passionate about pushing creative boundaries, delivering unforgettable and remarkable experiences through dance movements.
- A good choreographer and able to perform choreographed movements. ○ Creative expression to expand dance move vocabulary. ○ Physical control and precision in executing movements.
- Top-notch communication skills.

EDUCATION

White Dove Global Prep | *College Diploma / High school*

Computer Science, Mathematics and Economics

École des Sables | *International Professional Internship*

Black urban and contemporary dances / Danses urbaines et contemporaines noires

MOUNT KIGALI UNIVERSITY/ *Doing a Bachelor of Business Management*

PROFESSIONAL INTERNSHIPS

From July 15 to August 11, 2024, I participated in the International professional internship - Black urban and contemporary dances (Danses urbaines et contemporaines noires) which was held at the **École des Sables**, Toubab Dialaw, Senegal.

STRENGTHS & NON-TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Leadership: Able to motivate people of all ages and guide them to success.
- Various Dance Routines: Coming up with innovative yet culturally appropriate dance routines.
- Creativity: Creating Expressions and Physical endurance.
- Performance Art and Flexibility ○ Self-discipline. ○ Positive attitude and work ethics.
- Ability to communicate with choreographers, directors, and fellow dancers. ○ Collaboration and teamwork. ○ Adaptability and flexibility.

LANGUAGES

- English
- Swahili
- Kinyarwanda